

February 20, 2016

Docket # FDA 2015-D-3719

2016 FEB 26 A 10:37

To The Federal Drug Administration: My name is Isabel Lucas and I am from Calabash, North Carolina. I am now 63 years old and I would like this opportunity to explain my parkinson's disease and the stem cell treatment I received 2 years ago from Stem Genex.

I was not diagnosed correctly at Duke University Movement Disorder Clinic in 2010 when my symptoms first appeared at 58 years old. After 2 years of treatment I was told I did not have parkinson's disease. Being a disabled veteran I then went to MUSC in Charleston, SC and was told after a DAT scan that I did have parkinson's by Neurologist Dr. Hinson. I then proceeded to take Meripex ER 3 mg, 1x a day, Sinemet 100mg 2 tablets 4x a day and Amantadine 100 mg tablets 4x a day. This did control my severe right leg tremors and slight right hand tremors for awhile.

As my body got use to the medications that are 50 years old, I noticed a reduction in effectiveness. I then started my search for a cure or remission of symptoms. I was not interested in going to Mexico for obvious reasons, but after much research I came across Stem Genex and called to learn more about their procedures for my disease. The cost of the treatment was \$15,000. Money I did not have.

When I received my first VA disability check I decided that after going to support groups and seeing the stooped over, shaking, drooling parkinson's patients, that scared me to death. I was determined not to deteriorate to that extent, I called Stem Genex and paid for their treatment.

Upon arriving with my spouse and several patients with parkinson disease, we were professionally greeted and informed through meetings and lectures about the events occurring over the next 3 days. We were very pleased with their emotional and intellectual support. All anxiety was gone.

The procedure was painless during harvesting of my own adipose tissue and after processing my stem cells, they were injected up into my nose and given to me through IV therapy over a 2 hour time period. The support during this process was excellent. The 3rd day, feeling some discomfort from the liposuction procedure, I was again examined by the doctor and questions were answered. My bandages were changed and I was discharged to go home at 11 AM.

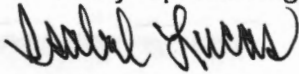
My spouse and I spent the entire day sightseeing with friends before boarding our flight home at 6PM to NC.

Within 1 week I noticed my sense of smell coming back. Something I had lost years before. Then gradually over the next few weeks I noticed my right sided tremors were decreasing and I could take less medication with significant reduction in tremors. I was very excited and pleased with the improvement everyone noticed. I finally went down to taking my medication only once in the morning and did not need it the rest of the day for several months. My energy level improved greatly and so did my constipation issues.

Gradually over the next 2 years, I needed to increase my medication back to where I was initially, but was not reporting any new symptoms which the puzzled the doctors. I am very happy I spent \$15,000. for the improvement I received but very unhappy that the FDA has not approved a procedure that simply gave me my life back. I need another procedure but cannot afford it. I keep in touch with a few patients I met at Stem Genex and some of them were able to afford their second treatment and are doing well. I am now full of fear and anxiety because my voice cannot be heard.

Please take the time to reconsider the evidence I have given to you. The rest of my young life is in your hands and I have given you the keys to the future of my peace and happiness and others afflicted with this horrible debilitating disease. I have served my county well and am very proud to be a female veteran. Now that I need my government, please don't let me down.

Sincerely representing parkinson's disease,



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P.S. I did listen to Michael J Fox webinar recently on stem cell research and was extremely disappointed in their lack of knowledge concerning adipose tissue treatment. Sometimes good doctors miss the evidence available out there.

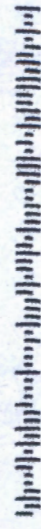
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